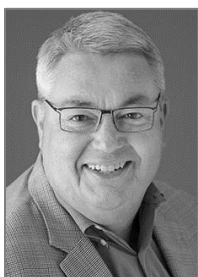




President's Report

by Scott Wilson '85



With the current hardship, loss, and uncertainty, it seems nearly impossible for us to know what lies ahead. Yet one thing

that is clearer than ever, is how important a community like Bowles Hall Residential College is for Cal students. We have seen this since we reopened in August 2016, and I have been especially aware of it again during spring and summer.

When they graduated in May, many of our seniors had lived in Bowles for all four years – the first time that has happened in a couple of decades! While the shelter order deflated their celebrations, it can't diminish their accomplishments or this milestone. We are working on a way to celebrate them personally this fall.

At the same time, our resident faculty, staff, and Hall Association pulled together to work through our response to the academic and social disruption brought on by COVID. I am beyond grateful for their commitment to doing whatever is necessary to ensure the wellbeing of our residents and the Hall's operational viability. They certainly didn't sign up for this, but

you wouldn't know it from the hard work they continue to do.

During this time, we have benefitted significantly from our good relationships with the campus. Dr. Lieu has been in regular contact with academic, health, residential life, and other Cal departments so that our COVID-related plans are aligned with theirs. Similarly, the engagement of the Foundation's Board of Directors – which includes faculty and senior campus administrators – has been extremely helpful.

All of this has been enabled by the efforts and generosity of many people since the BHRC project was first envisioned. Their generosity continues - as you will read in this newsletter. And we continue to grow our Alumni base, most recently with the Class of 2020!

So despite these very painful times, I believe that the mission of Bowles Hall Residential College is more vital than ever. Thank you for believing that as well. 🏰

A regular publication for the alumni, parents, and friends of the Bowles Hall Foundation (BHF) and those who support the re-establishment of the Bowles Hall Residential College experience in a restored Bowles Hall

July 2020

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Contact Scott

scottwilsonbhrc@gmail.org
+1 925 876 5480

BHF Financial Update

By Larry Jones '68



Like many of you, I've been part of the Bowles journey Bob Sayles started over ten years ago. As part of this, I led the Foundation's financing of our \$40M bond issuance in 2015 with the rest of the Foundation's management.

We initially financed this bond based on historical demand for on-campus housing; however, the COVID pandemic has aggressively challenged those assumptions since March of this year. While we are ready to reopen this fall, the protocols we are following with guidance from the University to limit ongoing risk to our residents have had meaningful financial implications for the Foundation.

We have been working closely with the University to coordinate our reopening plans for the fall. As of the time this is being written and assuming the fall semester runs smoothly, we expect minimal future impact on occupancy. This is because unlike other on-campus living options, Bowles only rents out single & double rooms. We will continue to work closely with the University to adjust plans and adapt as the situation changes and decisions evolve.

Currently, we are still assessing our exposure and the risks for the upcoming academic year to understand COVID's impact on our operations.

That being said, we expect to continue to meet all our debt service obligations as they come due for the upcoming academic year.

However, due to the curtailment of this academic year and the loss of what had been our expected summer program revenues, we have had to use a substantial portion of the existing cash reserves of the Foundation to cover our bills.

This has been by no means easy for us to stomach; however, we are prepared for the Foundation to fund upcoming debt payments, if necessary. As you've heard in the past, the Foundation funds the programmatic expense that make our rich student experience possible, and this increased burden has made donor giving more important now than it's ever been. The recently announced donor matching gift program is wonderful news. We do not receive money from the University for any component of our operations, so making up for shortfalls comes directly from our already limited resources.

Given the uncertainty ahead of us, we're focusing on what we can control, which is ensuring we provide the best residential experience possible while maintaining the highest safety standards for our students. As such, we will be implementing stringent safety measures to accomplish this (e.g. limiting capacity for gatherings, restricting outside guests at Bowles, implementing a quarantining policy, etc.), and will provide updates to the community as needed for any further changes that may impact day to day operations.

Our top priority remains to ensure our students' safety and accomplishing the Foundation's mission to provide a superior living-learning environment, and we look forward to resuming normal operations and activities as soon as possible. 

Primer on Bowles Finances

- Bowles Hall is operated by the Bowles Hall Foundation, a 501(c)(3) non-profit corporation that is independent from Cal
- Outstanding bond debt service payments are funded through day to day operations of Bowles Hall
- Bowles must meet a minimum Debt Service Coverage Ratio (Operating Income / Bond Payments) before the Foundation can share in net cash generated from operations with the University

Greetings from Our New Program Director

Hello! I'm Sophie Cushman, the new Program Director at Bowles Hall. I am a fourth-year PhD candidate in Classical Archaeology at Cal. I first heard about Bowles from two of my students several years ago during their first semester as Bowles residents and I am very

excited to have joined the community! Starting as Program Director in the time of COVID-19 has been unique, but I have already gotten to know so many residents. Whether it's attending Executive Committee and Hall



Sophie Cushman, Program Director

Association meetings each Sunday night, planning for future events with the Philanthropy Committee, or chatting about implementing the scholarship initiative, it's been great to learn about all the different projects going on at Bowles and to help residents come up with strategies to keep up the momentum on these programs for when we return in the fall. I have also begun helping to organize Welcome Week, when returning residents will come together to welcome new residents into the Bowles community. As a Graduate Student Instructor, I have worked with Cal undergraduates for several years and look forward to continuing to develop my role as advisor and mentor within the Bowles Hall community. 

2020 BHRC Officers

Scott Wilson ('85)

President

Leslie Peek (UC Davis '02)

Vice President

Larry Jones ('68)

Chief Financial Officer

Hal Berry ('57)

Treasurer

Isaac Jackson ('12)

Secretary

John Baker ('68)

President Emeritus

Additional Board Members

Sophia Brown-Heidenreich ('21)

Jacob Chabot ('19)

Glynda Hull, PhD

Robert Jacobsen, PhD

Harneet Kaur ('17)

Kevin Kennedy, JD

Dennis K. Lieu, PhD

Patricia Matteson, PhD

Nathan Mayer ('16)

Joshua McIntosh, PhD

Norman Mineta ('53)

Panos Papadopoulos, PhD

Antje Postema, PhD

David Presti, PhD

Steve Sutton, EdD

Principal's Update

By Dr. Dennis Lieu



The Spring semester started in what seemed to be a normal manner. With 182 residents in-house, everyone was looking forward to a semester filled with academic and social activities. But the worldwide pandemic caused by COVID-19 changed things practically overnight as all in-person classes on campus were cancelled and instruction went online in mid-March. At Bowles Hall, the top priority was protecting both the physical and mental health of our residents. In early March, two weeks before the University mandate for the change in all course delivery mechanisms, the resident staff at Bowles Hall had already prepared a three-step-plan in preparation for the eventual arrival of the virus in the area.

We were thus more prepared than most other housing venues in Berkeley, and we closely followed our plan with necessary supplies already in hand. Included in our actions were things like prolific education signage, daily disinfection of common areas, disinfectant and towels in all common areas, cancellation of in-house events, prohibition of visitors, availability of surgical and N95 face masks, and major modifications to our food service.

Following the lead of the campus dorms and I-House, we also offered an early lease termination date of 1 April with prorated housing costs. 135 of our residents took advantage of this offer, which saved them a lot of money and also decreased the density of remaining residents in the building for better social distancing. In fact, many residents had already left for an early spring break as soon as classes went online.

To protect the safety and health of those who had gone home, and that of those who were still in the building, residents were allowed to keep their belongings in their rooms until it was considered safe to travel again, and are planning to retrieve their things slowly over the summer. The 47 remaining Spring residents became a “quaranteam” the Hall for the rest of the semester.

This group became an even closer family, and even held a (socially distanced) Easter egg hunt to keep morale up. Full food service was provided all the way until the end of final exams. Mrs. Lieu continued to serve a socially distanced version of Tea Time every Tuesday. The group then held their own graduation ceremony, since the campus was forced to cancel its commencement plans.

The early lease termination offers and the cancellation of all summer programs in Bowles Hall has created a challenging financial position for the Hall. While the Foundation does have some financial reserves, we are looking at new ways to reduce expenses to keep the Hall affordable for its residents. Contributions are more appreciated than ever before.

The upcoming Fall semester looks promising. With the expectation that at least some, if not all, Fall classes will have some degree of in-person instruction available, Bowles Hall is recruiting a near full house with 32 incoming freshmen and 5 incoming transfer students. 82% of residents who were eligible to return in the Fall have signed leases. Another bright spot this semester was welcoming Sophie Cushman in April as our new Program Director. Sophie is a 4th year graduate student in Archaeology and comes with rich experience in leading student organized activities. She brings an added skill set, an extra set of hands, and a lot of enthusiasm to the residential staff. We are indeed grateful to have her. 



Social isolation has not affected the physical (or mental) health of Prof. and Mrs. Lieu

Dean's Update

By Dr. Antje Postema



All the clichés are right: this has been a challenging, unprecedented, and trying semester – and definitely one we’ll remember forever! It seems very long ago indeed that I was caught up in the Allegretto of Beethoven’s Seventh at SF Symphony, surrounded by three rows of spellbound Bowlesfolk. But that was only mid-January! We were blissfully raising a collective glass for another Founders’ Day celebration in February. And it was in early March that Chancellor Christ was at Bowles for a Fireside Chat, sitting cheek by jowl with dozens of unmasked students as she answered questions, and then genially shaking hands and posing for selfies afterwards. In the weeks and months that followed, it’s been important to concentrate on the things we were able to do together – instead of the Berkeley Marina clean-up day, the Spring Formal, the inaugural Bowles Graduation, and all the other events that COVID-19 forced us to cancel. Ultimately, we have managed to weather the changes the pandemic brought our way with all the patience, good humor, and grace we could muster. Through it all, I’ve been continually impressed by the resilience our residents have demonstrated and by the way they’ve remained engaged at Bowles even as many dispersed to various locations around the globe.

Perhaps unsurprisingly, though, these weeks have put a strain on the mental health of everyone – student and staff alike. Students have been concerned about their own health, as well as the health and well-being of loved ones near and far. They worry about the future: how they will compensate for summer opportunities that have been cancelled, what Fall semester classes will entail, how widespread and long-term will be the pandemic’s effects. As the semester wore on, they increasingly struggled with remaining engaged in online classes. They have been confused and frightened by a new campus-wide Pass/No-Pass

grading scheme. This was implemented with the express intent to decrease the amount of stress students felt about maintaining grades in an environment where they have much more on their academic and personal plates, and where the determination of fair grades had become well-nigh impossible (due to radically changed class structures and unequal access to technology). In reality, the policy has caused untold amounts of stress among the majority of Bowles (and Cal) students. I have counseled students on this and other issues, clarifying campus and Bowles stances, and talking through options and alternatives. As with so many things in this pandemic, there was not always one “right” choice, so I have encouraged students to be creative in figuring out ways to find and experience community, to stay focused, to alleviate stress, and to maintain a positive outlook.

While everyone has navigated the vagaries of quarantine, the transition to Zoom for all types of activities has certainly impacted how Bowlesfolk interact and communicate. In many cases, Zoom has facilitated conversations and kept students who have stayed at Bowles and those who have left in continued contact and joint enterprise on a number of essential projects. The Bowles Constitution was completely and finally drafted. This almost seemed miraculous, but was, in reality, achieved (as with most things around the Hall) through dint of focused student effort. A set of bylaws guiding community standards for communication over Slack, our social media platform, was drawn up and has already been actively implemented. Three new Undergraduate Fellows were selected to replace our capable graduating Fellows (Alex Reed, Chanan Walia, and Katie Willett). We received a large number of strong applications, and had a number of constructive discussions about Hall needs and the ever-evolving role of Undergraduate Fellows. I’m delighted to say that we will have four excellent Fellows this coming academic year: William Mullen, Emily Mustoe (continuing), Maeve Sneddon, and Della Qu.

Dean's Update (Cont.)

In breaking news, Cal Day was not cancelled at Bowles, but instead run totally online, complete with both a snappy new Youtube tour and a Facebook Live virtual tour and Q&A. Applicant numbers were reduced this year, but through a Zoom-mediated application process, we still netted strong new crops of continuing Cal students, freshmen, and and junior transfers. Whether Welcome Week will be in person or virtual is up in the air, but preparations for a warm and exuberant introduction of new residents to Bowles in August are well underway.

As we have made our way through altered, and sometimes cumbersome, versions of old standards on the Bowles calendar, it's become ever clearer that in this new season of Bowles Hall, our sights needs to be firmly set on expanding the limits of who is – and who ought to be – intentionally included in our community. Bowles Hall is no longer either the legendary establishment it was for decades after its original opening – nor is it the scrappy, fledgling place it was immediately after its grand reopening. We build on both of these preceding instantiations, and the current stability and groundedness of Bowles Hall allows us to focus less on mere survival, and more on how we can evolve into a more diverse and inclusive home, one that both reflects and respects our larger communities on campus and in the world. Particularly this semester, I have been working intently with Bowles students to facilitate honest conversations about the value of living and working with students from backgrounds different

from ones own, and the responsibility we have as a residential college on Cal's campus to cultivate and protect diversity. At this juncture, we must redouble our efforts to throw open our solid wooden doors to a much wider subset of students than we currently house – and, even more crucially, to ensuring that Bowles is a comfortable and hospitable place for every resident to shape according to their strengths and passions and to claim as their own.

Efforts to increase the diversity of Bowles Hall along all axes ultimately prompts us to reckon with the fundamental reason for our residents' relative lack of socio-economic diversity: the barriers to entry that Bowles poses because of its cost. I could not be more pleased that this semester was noteworthy for a reason besides COVID-19: we were able to offer modest scholarships to four residents, allowing them to stay at Bowles for another year. This was a ray of hope, both for the deserving recipients as well as the devoted scholarship committee that spent so many months preparing a mechanism for evaluating applicants and awarding funds. Much work remains as we gather the resources necessary for an ample and self-sustaining scholarship fund, but I am encouraged by these first steps.

As we embark on these first days of summer and look towards another year that is both uncertain and full of promise, I wish only good things to you and yours until we are able to meet again. 

WANT TO JOIN THE MENTORSHIP PROGRAM?

Bowles Hall is starting a mentorship program for the 2020-2021 academic year! If you are interested in participating in the Mentorship Program please visit bowleshall.org/mentor. The program is geared towards matching current residents with Bowles alumni based on academic and career interests in order to help students navigate through their undergraduate years, as well as build relationships within the broader Bowles Hall network.

The 1955 – 1965 Reunion

By Ron Bachman '59



On Friday evening 2/15/20, a group of Bowles Men returned to the Hall to spend an evening reliving our college days. For many of us this was our first return trip to Bowles since our graduation day. We did not take the climb up the steps as we did decades ago, in fact for many of us it was our own stress test. Those of our group who probably had a better GPA had their Uber Drive drop them off at the kitchen entrance. Since the reunion was for those of us that attended UCB in the years 1955-1965, we were all about 80ish and most of us were not in the same physical condition as when we lived at Bowles, and many had curtailed their night driving.

The evening started with a cocktail reception in the lounge for us “old guys” and attended by many of the current “Bowles Men”. Yes, even though Bowles is now coeducational, the women refer to themselves as Bowles Men. That tradition still lives on. At first, the alumni that were present seemed to visit more among themselves, but it did not take long for us to find out that the younger “Bowles Men” were considerably more interesting.

After introductions were made in the lounge, we made the short trip to the dining hall. Our dinners were served as they were when we were at Bowles – cafeteria style and open seating. Although wine was served in the lounge, it was not served in the dining hall. Some of us took the liberty of retracing our steps and bringing our own wine into the dining hall.

After dinner optional tours were given of the library and living quarters. The rooms did not look much different to me except they were single rooms for two instead of the three-room suites that we had. All in all it was a wonderful get together, and we look forward to continued participation with the Bowles community, especially providing mentorship to the students the next time we visit. 



Members of the classes of 1955-65 & significant others

Meet the New Marketing Committee

Nathalie Grogan and Jack Larkins are Bowles Hall’s new Marketing Chairs. As heads of the new Marketing Committee, the two are responsible for the publicity of the Hall, running the Hall’s Facebook page, overseeing the Instagram page, and working with the rest of the Hall to advertise Bowles to incoming freshmen and potential new residents.

Currently, Nathalie is creating a Blog on the new Bowles Hall website, which will feature posts written by a variety of residents about the Hall. Collectively, Nathalie and Jack have been working to advertise Bowles to incoming freshmen and transfers, using social media and messaging sites to connect with potential residents. Additionally, as COVID-19 has forced the University to cancel Cal Day, the two helped develop virtual tours and info sessions for potential residents. They look forward to increasing the visibility of Bowles and working with the Hall over future projects. 

Recent Alumni Spotlight: George Papadopoulos



The Papadopoulos Family

For George Papadopoulos, living in Bowles Hall was inevitable. His parents, both faculty at Cal, have been involved with Bowles since 2009 when Bob Sayles convinced Panos Papadopoulos, George's father, to help re-implement the residential college model at Bowles Hall. That same year, the eleven-year-old George greeted Bob Sayles for the first time, introducing himself as a member of the Cal Class of 2020. Eleven years later that statement has become reality: George takes pride in belonging to the Cal Class of 2020 and, by graduating a semester early, being the first student who completed his entire college career in the new Bowles Hall.

George graduated Phi Beta Kappa with a degree in Economics and Operations Research & Management Science and will start work this summer at a private equity firm in San Francisco. However, he will not slow down his involvement with Bowles. He has been giving back his free time to the Hall, including his work on redesigning the Bowles Hall website to ensure Bowles has a strong digital presence. Feel free to check out the new website at www.bowleshall.org.

Just as notably, George has pledged to remain committed to the Hall in the years to come. While being a part of the Bowles community was always a family affair in the Papadopoulos household, giving has become a family affair as well. In addition to the annual contribution his family normally makes, George has pledged a donation to name a room at the Hall over the next 5 years. While we look forward to George being a long-term donor, we are more excited about all the ways he is already giving back as an active member of the Bowles alumni community! 🏰

VISIT THE NEW BOWLES WEBSITE!

- 1 Take a Virtual Tour at bowleshall.org/tour
- 2 Read the student blog at bowleshall.org/blog
- 3 Donate at bowleshall.org/donate

Outgoing Hall President's Letter

By Alex Reed '20, Spring 2020 President



Certainly no one could have expected this semester to turn out the way that it did, but as with every other obstacle our Hall has faced, residents have met the unique challenges brought on by the pandemic with exceptional poise, diligence, and sagacity. Our regular Sunday Hall Meetings have continued uninterrupted, with members of the College tuning in via Zoom from all corners of the world to engage in thoughtful discussion and to help make decisions on everything from election by-laws to Hall improvement projects. The thirty-odd students who have remained at Bowles have likewise ensured that the Hall's most cherished traditions are not forgotten, working with the kitchen staff to organize a socially distanced backyard barbecue in lieu of the annual Beach Party and hosting a small graduation ceremony in the Greek Theatre to honor the five members of the Class of 2020 who stayed behind.

Even individual student committees, no matter where their constituents may be, have carried on with their work without hesitation. The Scholarship Committee—with the generous support of alumni, parents, and other friends of Bowles—has been forging ahead in its mission to bring greater socioeconomic diversity to the Hall and to find new means of enabling students in need to remain in residence. The newly established Marketing Committee has been working diligently to establish an online presence on a wide variety of social media platforms and to create a digital alternative to the usual Cal Day festivities. The

Application Committee recently met over the course of several days to select a new cohort of forty-seven incoming residents, composed of freshmen, junior transfers, and continuing Cal students, all of whom we are extremely eager to welcome at the earliest opportunity.

Most importantly, residents have continued to dedicate themselves not only to helping the Hall, but also to helping one another. When some students were unable to return home due to concerns over the health of parents and siblings or as a result of travel restrictions, others stepped up to welcome them into their own homes, caring for them as they would any other member of their family. Many students who remained at the Hall similarly offered a helping hand to those who were forced to leave belongings behind when hurriedly departing for the semester, boxing up and posting items for friends and neighbors. And every one of us has had the unique comfort of always having someone to talk to, a virtual trip back to Bowles just a click away thanks to the Hall Zoom, which supports a live audio/video feed to the Newman Dining Commons around the clock.

*Continued on
the next page...*

In the Next Issue:

- Hear from current Hall President Sophia Brown-Heidenreich on the start of another Bowles year
- Meet the Undergraduate Fellows

...and much more

CLASS OF 2020 GRADUATING SENIORS



Pictured from left to right:

Jenn Pezzuto, Katie Willett, Dr. Dennis Lieu, Drew Kim, Alex Reed, Nick Pingitore

Outgoing Hall President's Letter (cont.)

Amid the tragedy that has played out across the globe these past few months, Bowles has shown as a beacon of hope and strength for all of us. Our community has come together to offer aid when needed, to provide a sense of normalcy in these distinctively abnormal times, and of course to furnish the usual levity and hijinks. Our accomplishments, both together and as individuals, would have been historic even in an "average" semester, but given the circumstances they represent something truly remarkable. If so much can be achieved in such difficult times, I can only dream of what the future holds for this Hall.

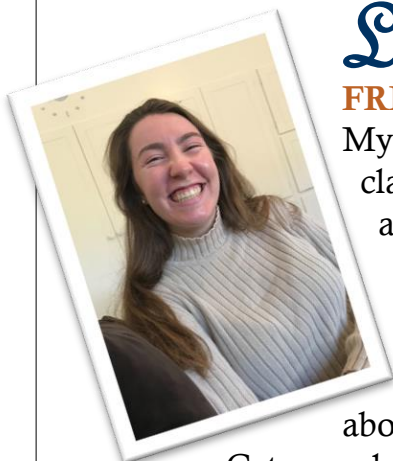
On a somewhat personal note, this Spring also marks the graduation of Bowles' first four-year class: eighteen seniors who entered the Hall when it reopened in the Fall

of 2016 and have called it home ever since. We have not only lived together, but we have learned and grown together as well, and each of us has left an indelible impression upon one another. As we scatter to the winds, some to academia, some to industry, some to public service, we are mindful of the great debt that we owe this Hall. As much as we have done to shape the community here, it has done all the more to mold us into the bold, thoughtful, spirited individuals that we are today, and for that we are grateful. We look forward to returning in the near future to celebrate this momentous occasion surrounded by the friends we made during our time here, and to once again shouting a hearty "Hello Bowles Hall!" and receiving a warm, familiar welcome home in reply. 🏰

2020 Graduating Seniors

Pietro Achatz Antonelli
Alexia Armstrong
Rubina Aujla
Andrew Boka
Celine Bookin
Enzo Cotter
Marc Davis
Patrick Donahue
Gabriel Fiandeiro
Ryan Hoque
Joseph Kelly
Sabrina Kharrazi
Andrew Kim
Kyle Kranen
Dominic LeDuc
Chester Leung
Neil Lugovoy
Swetha Manne
Yashodhan Mirashi
George Papadopoulos (Dec '19)
Jennifer Pezzuto
Nicholas Pingitore
Alexander Reed
Nick Scheuerman
Ethan Smith
Rohen Sukkawala
Jonathan Sun
Rohan Taori
Vanessa Travieso
Chanan Walia
Alexander Welty
Katherine Willett
Melanie Yu
Deborah Yuen

Class Representatives



Lily Litvak

FRESHMAN CLASS REP

My name is Lily, and I am the freshman class representative for the class of 2023! I am a MCB major with an intended focus in Biochemistry. At Bowles, I love hosting s'mores events, crazy dancing with my older sister Audrey and her roommate Celine, who live one floor above me, chair racing with my roommate Catey, and playing on the Bowles IM soccer team.

If you ever need to find me at Bowles, look for the girl with the ELF pajama pants and fuzzy socks at the hall meetings! When I'm not at Bowles, I am helping garden at People's Park with my sister Audrey and the rest of the People's Park Committee, all of whom are trying to help revitalize the park, or as of this spring, I will be volunteering at Highland Hospital in Oakland!

Class Representatives (cont.)



Abi & Jordan

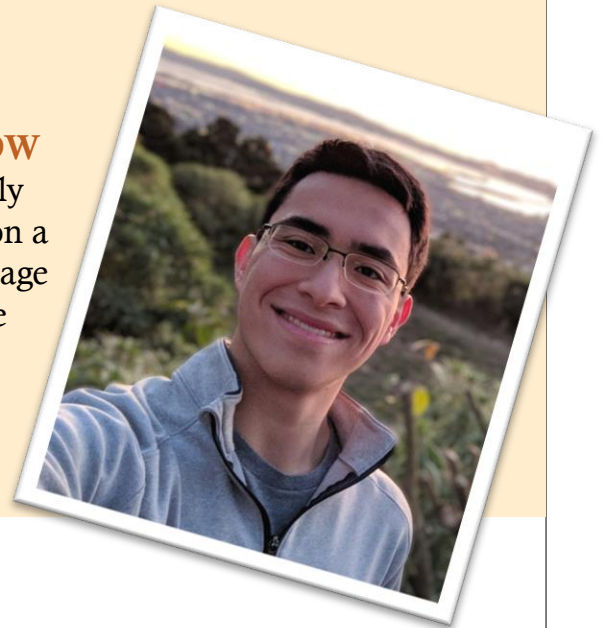
SOPHMORE CLASS REP

Abi and Jordan, next-door neighbors in the 5th floor of Bowles Hall, are excited to bring the sophomore class together in the spirit of scholarship, achievement and of course "fun times." Their class recently held a bagel (and pie) brunch, and they are enthusiastic in praise for their classmates, who bring life to the Hall in so many different ways. Abi, who sometimes goes by "A" or "B," and Jordan, who often goes by "Jordan," were most recently seen on Zoom, gently reminding their class that everything is going to be alright.

William Mullen

JUNIOR CLASS REP & UNDERGRADUATE FELLOW

William is a third year studying computer science originally from the DC metro area. While not in classes, he works on a research project in the RISELab, sound designs for BareStage (a student musical group), and rock climbs. At Bowles, he has also been working on writing a constitution for the hall. He plans to hold an excursion to an escape room or lead a group to get a climbing lesson!



Audrey Litvak

SENIOR CLASS REP

My name is Audrey, and I'm really excited to be representing the senior class! I have had the privilege of being roomies with my best friend, Celine '20, for the past three years in our little 512, and am now getting to room with my little sister,

Lily '23, for our last semester together. Bowles is home for us, and through organizing a Tahoe Ski Trip, holding intra- and inter-class socials, and getting involved in all of the amazing things other residents are doing, we try to make it home for anyone who walks through our doors. Outside of Bowles, I enjoy doing quite a lot of math, biochemistry, and gardening with Lily and friends at People's Park. 🏰

\$50K Matching Fund Set Up by the Class of '62!

When I read Scott Wilson's email from April 15, 2020, my wife, Joanne and I realized that we had to do something a bit out of the ordinary in our continuing financial support to Bowles Hall. I thought that we could do something that would amplify our donation. My email inbox is always filling up with donation requests that will be matched 100%, 200%, even 500%. So I thought that approach could work well for us and Bowles Hall in this COVID-19 induced crisis. I also realized that if I asked my Class of '62 buddies to contribute to a matching grant that we could significantly increase our collective donation.

I called eight of my classmate friends from 1962 and asked them to donate into a pool that would be matched 100%. All of them said yes and I received pledge promises of \$10,000, which, if fully matched, would generate a \$20,000 donation.

A few days later, I pitched the idea to the Bowles Hall Board of Directors. The response was very interesting. Not much was said at the time, but the next day, I received the remarkable news that someone, who remains

anonymous, was so inspired by the idea that they would add an additional \$40,000 matching donation. So there is now a potentially available donation of \$50,000! **This amount would come very close to eliminating using our reserves to fund the rest of this fiscal year.**

With this background, it is time for you, our loyal long-term supporters, to contribute and make this unique opportunity a reality.

Thank you all for your help!

-Ken Snow '62 

\$50K Goal



Gifts Received
As of 7/12/20

**\$30K ALREADY
RECEIVED!**

Give now at
bowleshall.org/donate
and have your gift
matched!

Update from Scholarship Committee

The issue of housing affordability has always been a deeply personal issue for the campus community. Despite university financial aid availability, the students, staff, and alumni of Bowles have increasingly realized the need for a Bowles Hall scholarship to ensure that all residents have a shot at the castle experience no matter their socioeconomic background. The Hall Association along with the Board of Directors, staff, parents, and alumni began the process of creating a sustained fundraising initiative for a scholarship last fall

In order to bridge the fundraising gap and support residents in the interim, the Board of Directors decided in February to provide some initial relief for low- and medium-income students with capital from an emergency fund. With their generous support, four current Bowles residents received scholarships that will allow them to live in the Hall for the 2020-2021 academic year. You can read about them on the following pages

Scholarship Recipients



My name is **Christian-Robert Barajas**, a transfer student and senior studying Music and Linguistics at Cal. Prior to moving to Berkeley I went the entirety of my life living in the strawberry capital of the world—Watsonville, CA. I am the son of migrant workers that labored in agriculture the majority of my childhood. Due to my family's socioeconomic situation education, housing and travel opportunities have only been made possible through scholarships and financial aid. While I have been at Cal the Bowles Hall experience has been the highlight of my collegiate journey. The sheer diversity of all our hall events, the intellect, THE BUILDING, and many other interactions that go on around me make up a framework that appeals and calls to me. I am so fortunate to be able to live in such a beautiful location and even more fortunate to be a scholarship recipient. This upcoming Fall semester I have been asked to sing a lead role in the Fall opera. I will also be completing the SCET entrepreneurship certification offered by Cal. For these plans an unexpected extra semester is needed and thanks to the generosity of our donors I am able to stick around and continue to embark on new explorations with my fellow bowlesfolk!

My name's **Nicole Chew**, and I'm a rising senior double majoring in Molecular Environmental Biology and English. Outside of Bowles, I'm a part of AFX and Cal VSA Lion Dance. Bowles has been a critical part of my college experience. I made so many friends just by living in the hall and always try to participate in as many events as possible throughout the years. The hall has always been a place where I've been able to relax, be myself, and know that there is a community that will support me. I lived in Bowles for my freshman and sophomore year, then moved out during my junior year for financial reasons. Through the year I wasn't living in Bowles, I still continued to come back and participate in the events and community, and I'm so grateful that this scholarship is giving me a chance to move back in and finish my college experience with some of my best friends and my fellow Bowleswomen and men! Thank you all for your continued love and support. 🏰



Bob Sayles Leadership Award

About the Award

The Robert A. Sayles Leadership Award is given to the individual or individuals who have demonstrated outstanding leadership skills and a deep sense of dedication to the Hall. Presented annually by the Bowles Hall Foundation Board of Directors, its recipient is a graduating senior.

The restoration and revival of Bowles Hall would not have been possible without the extraordinary effort of Robert “Bob” Sayles. In order to preserve the Hall’s soul and unique traditions preserve its history as one of Cal’s great institutions, Bob rallied support from hundreds of alumni and special friends as well as the broader Cal community. Bob founded the Bowles Hall Alumni Association in 2005 and later the Bowles Hall Foundation. So it is fitting that the Robert A. Sayles Leadership Award honors the student who inspires others with their leadership skills in the Hall and the greater campus community.

This year, the award was split between three deserving students, Nick Pingitore, Brenn Haydon, and Nilo Tehrani, all who have shown exemplary leadership during their time at Bowles.

Nick Pingitore

As a graduating senior, it’s safe to say that Bowles has very much been my life at Cal. As a member of the first “new” class in 2016, I immediately found my home within Bowles. I was drawn to the unique ability of Bowles to give my undergraduate career some sort of broader meaning, connecting me to students and alumni



across generations. In my time at Bowles, I’ve served as Assistant Social Secretary, Head of Light Entertainment for four semesters, and also as Hall President and a member of the Board of Directors for Spring of 2019. Undoubtedly, Bowles Hall has a legacy of fun. Yet with the reopening of the Hall, many important aspects of Bowles history and Hall culture stood to be lost. But in large part thanks to the efforts and leadership of the class of 2020, many of the events and traditions that

make Bowles what it is and connect us all to Bowlesmen and proudly now Bowleswomen, are alive and well. Luau, Spring Formals, The Thing, Raucous Big Game Parties, and perhaps even The Rites of Spring (not that I’d know anything about that...) are all alive and well. Having a share in maintaining and adapting these integral pieces of life at Bowles has not only made my college experience something I will remember for the rest of my life, but means that my shared experience holds common ground with someone who lived here fifty years ago, and likewise will bond me with someone living here fifty years in the future.

Bob Sayles Leadership Award (Cont.)

Brenn Haydon

My name is Brenn Haydon, and I am an English Major and Celtic Studies Minor from the small town of Auburn, California. Since becoming a part of the community and culture at Bowles Hall, I have always been dedicated to the well-being of Bowles Hall and its residents. Desiring to be involved in the crucial introduction and integration of incoming residents, I volunteered to be Head Coordinator for the 2019 Freshmen Welcome Week and spent many personal hours during my spring and summer months to perfect a week-long agenda. In this position, I oversaw the execution of all activities from Move-In Day, Open-Door Nights, Movie Night, Day in the Bay, and Brunch Meals, and specifically created and hosted the Welcome Ceremony. On an executive level, I have also served as Secretary for Spring 2019. Beyond this, however, I aspired to have an even more personalized impact with members of my community. For this reason, I further expanded my efforts to have weekly Tarot Card Readings in my room to provide residents with a unique opportunity for spiritual guidance. Nothing gave me more joy than being surrounded by my peers in a dimly-lit room asking 'the cards' questions about academics, love, and future goals. This year I also was able to officially host Reiki Energy Healing Sessions for residents. Being certified as a Reiki-practitioner, I offered thirty-minute Reiki sessions to all residents for free, coordinating appointments and meeting one-on-one with residents to further promote mental and physical wellness through the Hall. I am so grateful for all the positions and opportunities I have had to beneficially influence the Hall; I certainly found my niche within the community!



Nilo Tehrani

It is with great honor that I accept the Bob Sayles Leadership Award. From the moment I saw Bowles I knew that I wanted to give my all to this place. I mean, it's an easy thing to say when you first enter it; it is, after all, a very distinguished building. However, it is the people you meet on the inside who can truly push you to act on your aspirations. One of my friends Vanessa once said that living at



Bowles is like living in one house with all your distant cousins. Ever the comedian, she endeared a statement to me through laughter that I quickly found to be true in my Freshman year. As the time passes, I realize more and more that my colleagues and I may disagree, discuss and reform our perspectives and relationships. Yet, I always find myself circling back to the fact that I truly love Bowles and want to make everyone in it feel cared for and inspired to do great things, and break out of the obvious mould that has been designed for us in the world as students and

workers, but not as leaders. I wish for us to be strong. Standing together, respecting our differences but empowering and supporting each other, so that we may build each other up and be the absolute best and brightest we can be. This is my ongoing vision for Bowles. This is why I try to bring my best to the table, every day, with an open mind and an open heart. I hope that some of my projects, such as the Constitution, vegetable garden, annual pumpkin pie baking party, service on Executive Committee, and assistance in what seems like countless party set-ups and project meetings, has opened a platform for the students at Bowles to truly lead, express their individuality, and enjoy their short time here at Cal. 🇺🇸

In Memorial: Paul Larson, August 21, 1930 – September 27, 2019

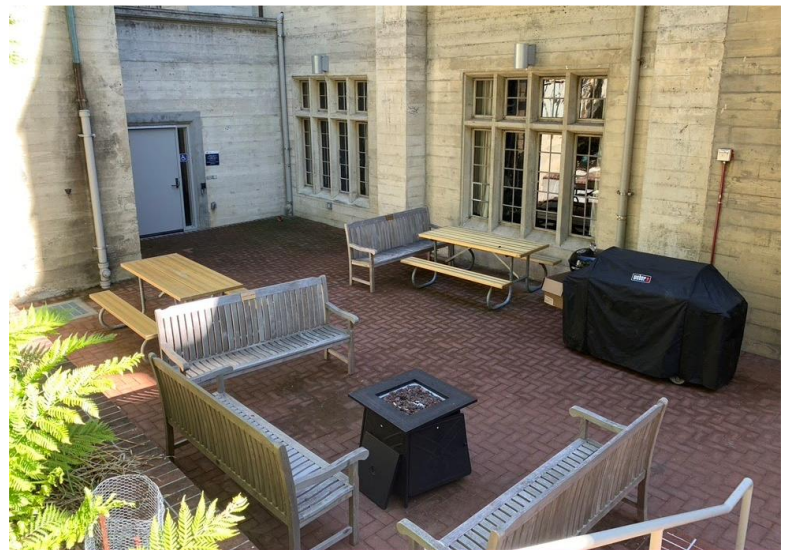


Paul Randall Larson passed away September 27, 2019, in Meridian, ID, but his heart was always in California. Paul was born in Berkeley August 21, 1930, to Oscar and Kathryn Randall Larson. Paul spent his early years in Avon, an oil company town outside Concord, where his father managed the Tidewater refinery. Paul later became a refinery manager himself but learned an important management lesson as a child watching his father: Treat everybody with respect.

Paul and his family moved to Concord in 1944, three years after Paul had already left Avon's one-room schoolhouse for Concord Grammar School. At the more populated grammar school, there were enough students to actually play football during recess, and Paul developed an enduring love of the game. As an eighth-grade memory book indicates, he developed an enduring love for someone else, too; on one page, his class noted Paul L. was fond of J. H. — and J. H., of P. L.

J. H. was Juanita "Boots" Hosking, and had there been a high-school or college memory book, it might as well have said the same thing. Paul and Boots graduated together in 1948 from Mt. Diablo High School (Concord) and in 1952 from UC-Berkeley, where, after a brief stint playing college football, Paul decided he'd better focus on mechanical engineering instead. A family friend saw his potential and urged Paul to consider grad school. Boots agreed, so the couple wed September 12, 1952, in Concord, then hightailed it for Newton, MA, where Paul earned a master's in chemical engineering at MIT in 1954.

It was the first of many moves for the Larsons. During his 38-year career with Chevron, Paul transferred to almost as many places as he did positions. His jobs included foreman, designs engineer, operations engineer, assistant superintendent, operations manager, and refinery manager; and his work took him and his family to Richmond, CA; El Paso, TX; Maracaibo, Venezuela; El Segundo, CA; Salt Lake City, UT; and Pascagoula, MS. The Larsons returned to Paul's childhood home in Concord in 1976 when Chevron transferred him to San Francisco, where he retired as VP of Supply and Distribution in 1992.



The Paul & Boots Larson 1952 Patio

Although happy to finally be home, Paul was no homebody. He and Boots were active members of the Concord Historical Society, and they both put their green thumbs to good use volunteering at The Gardens at Heather Farm. When they weren't busy serving their community, they could be found traveling the world or cheering on Cal at Memorial Stadium.

Paul was never one to raise his voice, unless it was to shout, "Roll on, you Bears!" Paul was preceded in death by Boots and his parents. He is survived by his children, Randy (Mary), Kathryn (Bill) England, Mat (Sharon), and Scott (Vicki); five grandchildren; seven great-grandchildren (one of whom has the honor of being his namesake!); brother, Charlie (Sue); and Charlie's two children, three grandchildren, and great-granddaughter. 

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☐ **Scholarship:** Help support the long-term financial well being of Bowles Hall Residents

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